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The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388 sastamps.org T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR 2021

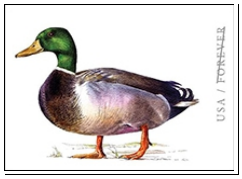
MAY			JUNE		
?	NO MEETING		?	NO MEETING	
?	NO MEETING		?	NO MEETING	
?	NO MEETING		?	NO MEETING	
?	NO MEETING		?	NO MEETING	

Please read page 3 for information about possibly starting meetings soon. Of course, we will still need to be careful, and follow safety rules, but it will be good to see all of our friends once more.

EDITOR'S CORNER NEW STAMPS FOR MAY & JUNE, 2021

May 4-Star Wars Droids Forever Stamps-the second Star Wars issue will salute the "beloved droids from the Star Wars galaxy and the imagination that brings these technological marvels to the screen.

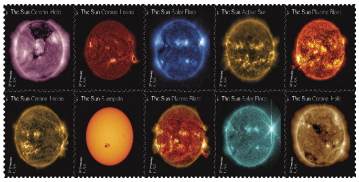
May 17-Heritage Breeds Forever Stamps-These stamps pay tribute to heritage breeds, preindustrial farm animals that are enjoying renewed attention for their versatility, adaptability and unique genetic traits.



June 1-Mallard Forever Stamped Card - The mallard duck is very adaptable and breeds throughout most of the United States, even in urban areas.

Go for Broke: Japanese American Soldiers of WWII Forever Stamp-recognizing the contributions of some 33,000 Japanese American soldiers, who served in the U.S. Army during WW II.

June 10 - Emilio Sanchez ForeverStamps-The art of Emilio Sanchez (1921-1999) is celebrated with four new stamps featuring his colorful architectural lithographs and paintings.



June 18-Sun Science Forever Stamps-These 10 stamps show digital images of the sun's activity taken from NASA's Solar Dynamics Observatory.

June 24-Yogi Berra Forever Stamp-Honoring Yogi Berra (1925-2015), one of the best and most baseball players of his era, winning a record 10 World Series with the New York Yankees.

.Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
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Mailing Jack Virta

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SAPA meets at MacArthur Park Lutheran Church, 2903 Nacogdoches Rd, every Friday night at 7:30 pm in Bldg. #1, facing Nacogdoches Rd. Yearly dues are $20.00, prorated.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
Vice President:	Chip Swinney
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chair:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chair:	George Garten
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Chip Swinney
Assistant Auctioneers:	Steve Mabie

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Jack Virta
One year term:	Nancy Mabie
Two year term:	Lea Senghaas
Parliamentarian:	Harry Greer
Honorary Board Member	Kathy Beer

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Texas Philatelic Association:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
APS Circuit Books	Dr. Eric Shepherd

WE WELCOME VISITORS

Please view our website **sastamps.org** for information on our meeting schedules

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

While your purchases will be given to you during the auction, please wait until the end of the auction to pay for them. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks made out to S.A.P.A. are acceptable. Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

President's Message

Fred has informed the board that there is some hope that the church meeting room may be available sometime in June for in-person meetings. All of this is dependent on how things go with the churche's initial opening for services, choir practice, school, etc. and the Covid situation in San Antonio.

There have been suggestions by some members that we start meeting in an alternate location in May or June. A number of members have already indicated that they are not in favor of this this. Trying to move to an alternate location for one or two months may be too disruptive. There is also the question of access to club supplies stored at the church.

My proposal to the membership is that we start back to in-person meetings with an abbreviated schedule of just two meetings a month. On the second Friday of the month we will have a combination business meeting, show & tell and short presentation of some kind. On the forth Friday of the month we will have our club auction. If the church opens the meeting hall in June we will start then, otherwise we can plan to start in July. We can do this schedule until members indicate they are ready to go back to an every Friday schedule. When we do start in-person meetings we will follow the current guidelines of masks, separation and sanitation.

Let me or one of the other board members know what you think. When we are ready to start meeting again we will send out an announcement in the newsletter and by E-mail. The club has gone without meeting for over a year. We can bear another couple of months to be safe.

Dr. Eric Shepherd

May 2021 phone **210-906-2655**

ECShepPhD@aol.com

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

May 7-8 **SAN ANTONIO TSDA**, Norris Conference Center, 618 Northwest Freeway Loop 410 (across San Pedro from NorthStar Mall), San Antonio, TX 78216 (Friday 10-5, Saturday 9-4)

May 21-22 **HOUSTON TSDA,** Crowne Plaza Hotel, 7611 Katy Freeway (IH-10 West), Houston, TX 77024. (Friday 10-5, Saturday 9-4)

Jun 25-26 DALLAS TSDA Doubletree Hotel, Bluebonnet Room, 1981 North Central Expressway (Hwy 75 & Campbell Rd), Richardson, TX 75080 (Fri 10-5, Sat 9-4)

TSDA - https://www.tsdastamps.com is the Texas Stamp Dealers Association's website. If you wish to attend any show listed for them in our newsletter, please check this site to make sure the show is going forward, and has not been cancelled for any reason

Fred's Corner

Flickering Light at the end of the Covid Tunnel

An update on the situation at the MacArthur Park Lutheran Church:

Secretary Pat talked with Kevin today; he is in charge of the church's building and property. As noted on the church website, Kevin said the first in-person service will be held this Sunday in the Sanctuary. Attendance is limited to 50 persons who have reserved places. Attendees will have to follow Covid procedures of mask wearing, distancing, etc, while in the building.

Kevin said that in around a month they will reopen the "Education Building" for school and choir activities.

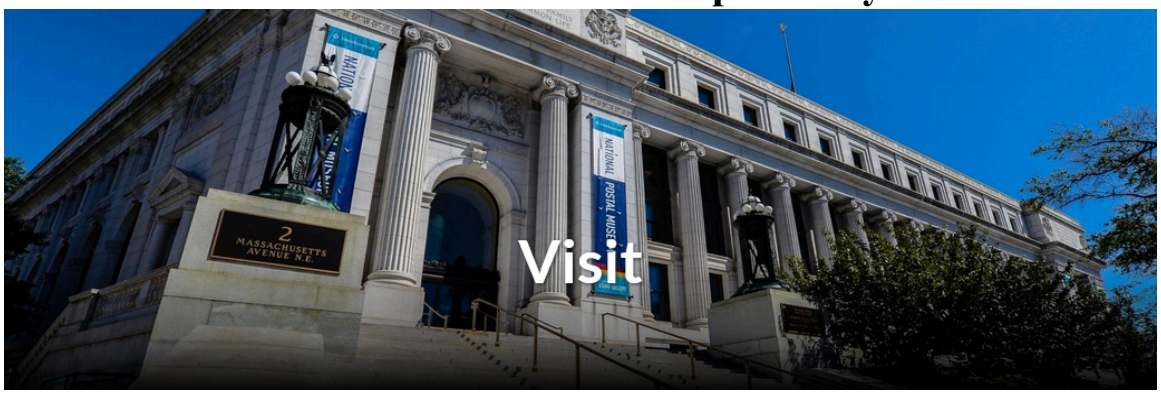
My comments: I presume the church will move cautiously forward. Based on its experiences with Sunday services, choir practices and the like, it will later consider reopening the meeting hall for social meetings like SAPA. Of course, the Covid situation in San Antonio and Bexar County will play a major role in the church's moves.

As I wrote in the subject line above, there is a little light at the end of the Covid tunnel. If you know any SAPA members who do not use email, please notify them of this news.

Stay safe! *Fred Groth, Treasurer*

LTC519@satx.rr.com

The Smithsonian National Postal Museum in Washington DC announces its "William H Gross Stamp Gallery."



Named after its primary benefactor, the National Postal Museum's William H. Gross Stamp Gallery is the world's largest gallery dedicated to philately. It provides an experience available nowhere else and offers something for everyone, from casual visitors to experienced collectors.

As visitors move through six thematic areas, stunning displays and interactive moments reveal the amazing stories that unfold from the museum's unparalleled collection. Distributed throughout the thematic areas are hundreds of pullout frames containing more than 20,000 objects, providing ample opportunities to view noteworthy stamps that have never been on public display.

The URL for the Museum is https://postalmuseum.si.edu

The URL for the Gross gallery: https://postalmuseum.si.edu/exhibition/william-h-gross-stamp-gallery

This gallery consists of the following galleries that can be visited virtually:

World of Stamps - As visitors step into this introductory gallery, a display of oversized stamps and video monitors grabs their attention. Video images bring stamps to life and pique curiosity through questions that are answered as visitors explore the surrounding displays. View the virtual exhibition.

Mail Marks History - The markings on mail provide valuable clues to the surprising ways mail has been transported over time, including challenges and even disasters encountered along the way. Visitors learn to decipher these markings through an interactive experience in which they trace the journeys of three historic letters by analyzing different kinds of mail markings.

National Stamp Salon - Here, philatelists and other interested visitors have access to some of the great U.S. collections owned by the National Postal Museum or on loan from other institutions. 275 pullout frames display tens of thousands of stamps and pieces of mail from the National Philatelic Collection along with the Postmaster General's and Benjamin K. Miller collections. A large case displays medals, handstamps, dies, and other historic artifacts from the National Philatelic Collection.

Stamps Around the Globe - International stamps make up more than half of the National Postal Museum's collections. At interactive displays flanking a large globe, visitors explore examples of how stamps reflect their countries of origin and connect people, places, and cultures worldwide.

Connect with US Stamps - In this highly interactive area, visitors are immersed in examples of how stamp content, design, and production have changed over time and how modern U.S. stamps reflect the nation's identity. Here, too, visitors explore their own connections with stamps.

Gems of American Philately - Like gems of the mineral world, these stamps and pieces of mail are rare and highly valued. They tell stories about important moments in U.S. history, from the Stamp Act and the American Revolution to the Apollo 15 Moon landing. Each one conveys significant information about stamp design and production, including one of the most famous stamp printing errors ever made.